

SCOTT BRANT

Cloud Architect | AI Systems Builder | DevOps Engineer

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Profile

Senior Cloud Engineer and builder with 15+ years of experience designing and scaling Azure-based platforms. Combines deep infrastructure expertise with product innovation, including founding and launching GridMind, a live AI-driven platform. Author of work on Agentic AI in DevOps. Known for translating complex systems into scalable, cost-efficient solutions.

Experience

Senior Cloud Infrastructure DevOps Engineer, Degreed; Remote — 2018–Present

- Ran Azure-only infrastructure for degreed.com, helping scale from startup to global enterprise.
- Increased security posture through audit readiness, certifications, and compliance with InfoSec.
- Shifted workloads to Kubernetes microservices and Terraform IaC, reducing costs.
- Led design/implementation of multi-region Azure (App Services, Front Door, SQL, Key Vault, AVD).
- Introduced agentic AI tools into DevOps workflows, accelerating delivery and efficiency.
- Saved the business hundreds of thousands annually by utilizing more efficient resources and practices.

Sr. Infrastructure Engineer, Atmosera; Beaverton, OR — 2015–2018

- Architected Azure, hybrid, and private cloud environments across datacenters.
- Provided tier 3/4 support for MS/Linux servers, VMware, Hyper-V.
- Built Azure and hybrid solutions, authored policies, hardened environments for compliance (PCI, HIPAA, HITRUST).
- Led VDI deployments with 99.999% uptime for manufacturing clients.
- Awarded multiple leadership recognitions.

IT Manager, Xerox; Portland, OR — 2011–2015

- Supported 18k+ global users across 35 sites with full IT operations.
- Designed VMware View and Citrix deployments for 5k+ users.
- Saved \$1.3M via virtualization; delivered \$2M savings in refresh projects.
- Directed IT budgets, audits, and staff across multiple regions.

Network Administrator, Xerox; Portland, OR — 2007–2011

- Managed network/domain access for 700+ users, Cisco routing/switching, Windows servers.
- Ensured record-setting uptime with redundant systems.
- Handled firewalls, updates, backups, and emerging technology planning.

Projects & Ventures

Founder — GridMind (AI Energy Platform)

- Founded and built GridMind, a live AI-powered platform designed to optimize and automate complex energy system decisions.
- Engineered scalable cloud architecture with a strong focus on reliability, security, and cost efficiency
- Developed agentic AI workflows to enable autonomous planning, execution, and optimization.
- Owned full product lifecycle from idea to production, including system design, infrastructure, and user experience.
- Demonstrates applied expertise in AI + DevOps integration beyond traditional enterprise environments.

Publications

Author — Agentic AI & DevOps

- Wrote and self-published a professional book.
- Covers strategies for integrating agentic AI into Azure, DevOps practices, cost optimization, and real-world case studies.
- Available on Amazon and other platforms.

Education & Certifications

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate
- VMware Certified Associate – Cloud (VCA-C)
- VMware Certified Associate – Data Center Virtualization (VCA-DCV)
- Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP)
- Mt. Hood Community College, Portland, OR — 2004
- Heald College, Portland, OR — 2003
- Parkrose High School, Portland, OR — 2003 Graduate

Skills

Cloud & DevOps: Azure, Terraform, Helm, Kubernetes, IaC, App Services, SQL, Redis, CDN, WAF

Security & Compliance: Cloud governance, FinOps, Disaster Recovery, Compliance (PCI, HIPAA, HITRUST, SOC2, ISO27001, TSAX)

Networking & Infrastructure: Cisco, Palo Alto, Fortigate, VMware, SANs, NetApp, PureStorage

AI Tools: Factory.ai, Cursor, Augment, GitHub Copilot